Policy & Strategy Lab

Decision Log

Every design decision is recorded here before any material depends on it. Approved decisions are not changed silently: a change gets a new entry that names the entry it replaces and lists the materials that must be revised.

Status key. Approved: confirmed by the course director. Adopted: set out in the master project brief and treated as approved unless revised. Provisional: the course director left the choice open or undecided, so the designer's recommendation is in use until it is reviewed. Deferred: to be settled at a later stage. Proposed: recommended, awaiting a decision. Open: no recommendation yet.

Approved, adopted and provisional

ID	Date	Decision	Status	Basis	Materials affected
DL-001	Before 10 Nov 2026	The student course runs for 20 teaching days over four weeks, Monday to Friday	Approved	Course director	Calendar; all day-wise material
DL-002	Before 10 Nov 2026	Two hours of live teaching per day, 40 hours in total	Approved	Course director	Session plans; PPT blueprints
DL-003	Before 10 Nov 2026	Format: live teaching, daily group activities and individual workbook application	Approved	Course director	Session plans; activity bank; workbooks
DL-004	Before 10 Nov 2026	Participants select their own Indian policy cases	Approved	Course director	Case Approval Form; feasibility rubric
DL-005	Before 10 Nov 2026	Learning model: live group problem-solving with individual submissions	Approved	Course director	Pods; assessment

ID	Date	Decision	Status	Basis	Materials affected
DL-006	Before 10 Nov 2026	Assessment: individual workbooks and a final group presentation. Weights provisional: workbooks 35, research and evidence 15, group work and peer review 10, individual report 20, presentation and defence 20	Approved in principle; weights provisional	Course director	Rubrics; capstone
DL-007	Before 10 Nov 2026	Primary training outcome: consulting and strategy problem-solving skills	Approved	Course director	Learning outcomes
DL-008	Before 10 Nov 2026	Identity: intellectual depth combined with consulting-style execution	Approved	Course director	Concept note; all materials
DL-009	Before 10 Nov 2026	Working title: Policy & Strategy Lab	Adopted	Master project brief	Branding; certificate
DL-010	Before 10 Nov 2026	The McKinsey seven-step process is the organising spine	Adopted	Master project brief	Curriculum
DL-011	Before 10 Nov 2026	Visual identity: white backgrounds; navy #123B63, strategy blue #2F5F8F, accent #4D82B8, pale blue #EAF1F7, text #202B36, secondary text #667482, rules #D7E0E8; Aptos with Arial fallback; 16:9; dot-and-dash markers; no stock imagery, gradients or decorative icons	Adopted	Master project brief, Part XI	All PPTs and workbooks
DL-012	Before 10 Nov 2026	Citation style: Chicago Notes and Bibliography for academic material	Adopted	Master project brief	Readings; instructor notes; source register
DL-013	Before 10 Nov 2026	Writing standard: no em dashes; no generic filler; British spelling	Adopted (British spelling proposed, in use)	Master project brief	All documents
DL-014	Before 10 Nov 2026	Production runs in twelve stages; no PPTs before the intellectual architecture is settled	Adopted	Master project brief	Production plan
DL-015	10 Nov 2026	Primary audience: final-year undergraduates, postgraduates and early-career professionals (up to about three years), with an entry diagnostic for placement	Provisional	Course director: "you see" (left to designer)	Learning outcomes; session pitch; publicity

ID	Date	Decision	Status	Basis	Materials affected
DL-016	10 Nov 2026	One anchor tool per day, at most two supporting tools demonstrated; revised 20-day architecture accepted in principle	Provisional; review at Stage 4	Course director undecided; designer's recommendation (Concept Note R1, 16.2)	Curriculum; framework library; PPTs
DL-017	10 Nov 2026	Every case names a decision-making role and the decision it faces. The client is a role (for example, a District Education Officer); participants never contact the office	Provisional; review after Stage 2	Course director undecided; designer's recommendation (Concept Note R4)	Case Approval Form; LO1; report format
DL-018	10 Nov 2026	Completion and distinction standard	Deferred to Stage 8. Working assumption for writing indicators: Working level in all domains	Course director: "we will see"	Rubrics; certificate
DL-019	10 Nov 2026	No primary research. All evidence is published or publicly available; no interviews, surveys or observation	Approved (interpreted from "No"; confirm if interviews were meant to be required instead)	Course director	Day 13; LO6; competency E5; ethics norms
DL-020	10 Nov 2026	Capstone format: client report due 72 hours after Day 20; full deck submitted; five-slide, six-minute presentation; six-minute individual defence; 500-word sealed-answer reflection	Approved	Course director	Capstone; Day 19 and 20 plans; rubrics

Proposed and open

ID	Decision	Recommendation	Status	See
P-07	Cohort size	12 to 16 for the first run	Proposed	Concept note 9.6, 12
P-08	Delivery mode	Online, in person or hybrid	Open	9.7
P-09	Teaching team and Day 20 panel	One instructor plus two guest panellists	Proposed	18.2
P-10	Pod composition	Same state or city, different problems	Proposed	9.3
P-11	Spine case	Waste segregation in a named city, or foundational literacy in a named district	Open	10.4
P-12	Gate mechanics	Formative gates and a summative portfolio	Proposed	11
P-13	Software	Free tools, with Microsoft Office versions of templates	Proposed	15
P-14	Pre-course week	Include: diagnostic, case shortlist, spreadsheet primer	Proposed	10.1

ID	Decision	Recommendation	Status	See
P-15	"Research and evidence quality" (15%) becomes a distinct artefact, the evidence register	Accept; weights otherwise unchanged	Proposed	11
P-16	Presentation and defence (20%) split into individual 15 and pod synthesis 5	Accept	Proposed	11, 12
P-17	Ten workbooks aligned to gates, with numbered daily worksheets	Accept	Proposed	16.1 R12; Stage 2 section 4
P-18	Rubrics operate at domain level (ten descriptors); competency IDs used to point feedback, not scored separately	Accept	Proposed	Stage 2 section 11
P-19	A pod-reviewed check of the options appraisal on Day 17, so that Week 4 work gets feedback before the summative assessment	Accept	Proposed	Stage 2 section 11